Monday 2 March 2026

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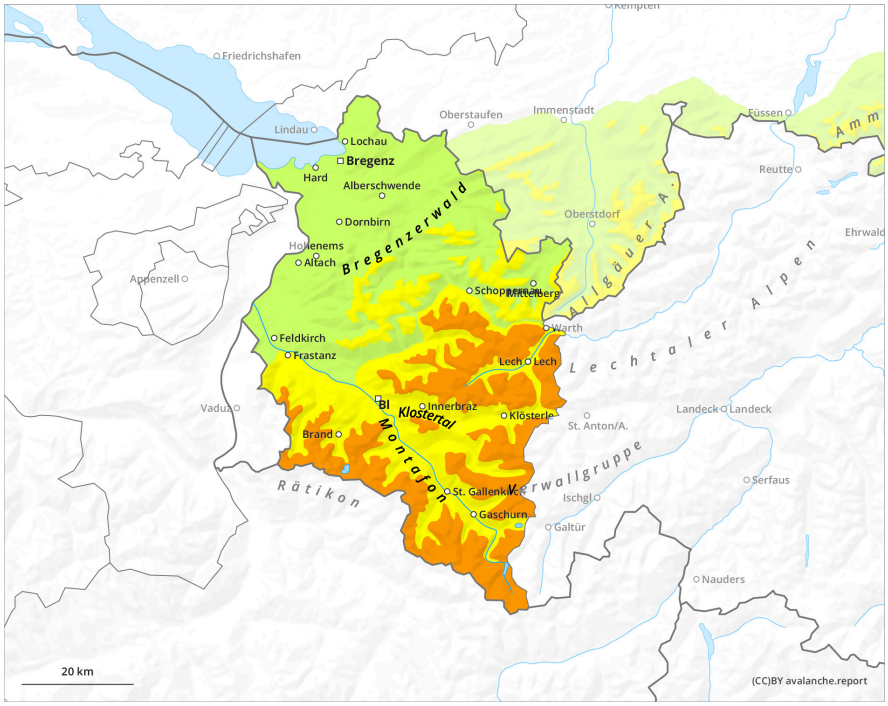
Written by Bernhard Anwander

In backcountry touring terrain: weak old snow.



1	2	3	4	5
low	moderate	considerable	high	very high

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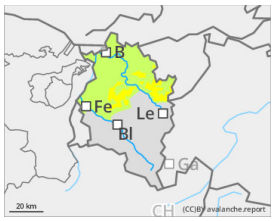
Danger Level 2 - Moderate

1600m

Tendency: Constant avalanche danger
on Tuesday 3 March 2026



Wet snow

1600m

Persistent
weak layer

1800m

Main danger: weak old snowpack

Avalanche danger above 1600m is moderate, below that altitude danger is low. One single winter sports enthusiast can trigger avalanches on very steep shady slopes above 1800m which fracture down to deeper layers of the snowpack, particularly where the melt-freeze crusts are not capable of bearing loads. Danger zones occur most often in relatively shallow-snow places and in transitions from shallow to deep snow. In addition, above 1600m isolated moist slab avalanches can be triggered by winter sports enthusiasts in the weak old snow. Avalanches can fracture down to deeper layers inside the snowpack and grow to medium size. During the daytime hours, small wet-snow and glide-snow avalanches can trigger naturally in steep sunny terrain. Avoid zones beneath glide cracks.

Snowpack

Above 1800m on shady slopes, weak layers still occur in the lowermost part of the snowpack. During nights of clear to cloudy skies, the snowpack surface freezes only poorly. As a result of solar radiation and daytime warming, the snowpack rapidly softens during daytime hours.

Weather

Dry mountain weather, very little wind, it will turn quite sunny, only from Montafon to the Arlberg will heavy cloud cover prevail. Clear and bright nighttime skies with a full moon. Temperature at 2000m: -1 to +1 degree; at 3000m: -7 to -5 degrees. Light westerly-to-southwesterly winds at high altitudes.

Tendency

As a result of daytime warming and solar radiation, danger of wet-snow avalanches increases somewhat during the course of the day. The persistent weak layer problem persists, causing a difficult-to-calculate situation in outlying terrain.